

Meilisearch for Olam Agri

Simple, practical plan for rollout

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1. Purpose

This report answers one question: Is Meilisearch a good fit for Olam Agri? The short answer is yes, if it is used as a search layer and not as a source system. The plan below explains where it fits, what risks to watch, and how to roll it out in a controlled way.

2. What Meilisearch should do

Meilisearch should power fast search for users. Source systems (like SAP) remain the place where data is created and updated. Data should first go through a middleware service, then be indexed in Meilisearch. This makes data mapping, retries, and access control easier to manage.

Part	Role in simple terms
Source systems	Keep the official data and business rules
Middleware service	Clean, reshape, and send data to search index
Meilisearch	Return fast search results to users
Web / app clients	Call search APIs and show results

3. Key performance point

Indexing can use a lot of memory and CPU. If indexing is not controlled, user search can become slow. So the rollout must use fixed limits for indexing memory and threads, plus smaller index batches.

- Set a clear memory cap for indexing.
- Set a clear thread cap for indexing.
- Use smaller and regular update batches.
- Track queue size, indexing time, and search latency every day.

4. Deployment choice

Option	When to choose it
Community Edition (self-hosted)	Good for first rollout and focused workloads
Enterprise Edition (self-hosted)	Needed when high availability and horizontal scale are mandatory
Meilisearch Cloud	Good when team wants less infrastructure management

5. Main risks and fixes

- **Risk:** Data mapping from SAP tables to search documents is complex. **Fix:** Start with one business domain and a fixed schema contract.
- **Risk:** Heavy indexing slows search. **Fix:** Use strict indexing limits and staged updates.
- **Risk:** Search keys exposed in frontend. **Fix:** Issue short-lived tenant tokens from backend only.
- **Risk:** Weak restore process. **Fix:** Run backup and restore drills before go-live.

6. 12-week rollout plan

Time	What to deliver
Weeks 1-2	Pick one use case, define document schema, define response-time target
Weeks 3-4	Build first index and secure API access
Weeks 5-8	Automate updates from source systems and improve relevance
Weeks 9-12	Load test, backup/restore test, staged production release

7. Final recommendation

Proceed with Meilisearch using a narrow first scope. Keep architecture simple: source systems -> middleware -> Meilisearch -> apps. Make performance limits and security controls part of day-one setup. Expand only after the first domain is stable and measured.

References

- Meilisearch Docs: FAQ
- Meilisearch Docs: Configuration
- Meilisearch Docs: Security and tenant tokens
- Meilisearch Docs: Community and Enterprise editions
- Meilisearch Docs: Performance guidance for indexing